SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

1 September 2023 · Shift 2

44 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 46 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.14

A sum of money deposited at simple interest amounts to ₹1,020 in three years and ₹980 in two years. The sum deposited is:

(A) ₹900
(B) ₹880
(C) ₹920
(D) ₹840

General Awareness 19 questions

Q.1

In which of the following states is there hardly any differences in day and night temperatures?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Bihar
(C) Kerala
(D) Punjab

Q.3

The dancers Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarmel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy and Anita Ratnam are great exponents of _____.

(A) Mohiniyattam
(B) Odissi
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Kathak

Q.4

Which of the following states won the Santosh Trophy in Riyadh in March 2023 after a gap of 54 years?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.5

Which of the following statements is correct about Article 129 of the Constitution of India?

(A) It provides for the Supreme Court to give advisory opinion to the President.
(B) It provides for the Supreme Court to be a court of original jurisdiction
(C) It provides for the Supreme Court to be a court of record.
(D) It provides for the Supreme Court to be the highest court of appeal.

Q.6

Indian classical vocalist Pandit Jasraj belonged to which of the following musical gharanas?

(A) Patiala Gharana
(B) Dagari Gharana
(C) Gwalior Gharana
(D) Mewati Gharana

Q.7

Articles 29-30 of the Constitution of India deals with _____

(A) Cultural and educational rights
(B) Right to freedom
(C) Right to equality
(D) Right to freedom of religion

Q.8

As per the 18th Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), the unemployment rate among females (aged 15 years and above) in urban areas declined to _____ in January-March 2023.

(A) 9.7%
(B) 9.2%
(C) 7.8%
(D) 8.2%

Q.9

Which of the following is connected with daily atmospheric weather changes?

(A) Asthenosphere
(B) Stratopause
(C) Troposphere
(D) Lithosphere

Q.10

According to the Census of India 2011, which of the following states has the lowest literacy rate?

(A) Kerala
(B) Tripura
(C) Goa
(D) Mizoram

Q.11

In which state is the famous Brihadeshwar temple situated?

(A) Kerala
(B) Karnataka
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.13

Which of the following is an example of capital receipt in the government budget?

(A) Sale of government bonds
(B) Income from government-owned enterprises
(C) Tax revenue collected from citizens
(D) Grants received from foreign countries

Q.14

Which of the abhinayas deals with the use of costumes, jewellery, facial make-up etc?

(A) Vachika Abhinaya
(B) Aharya Abhinaya
(C) Sattvika Abhinaya
(D) Angika Abhinaya

Q.16

Which of the following best defines transfer payments?

(A) Payments made to individuals in exchange for their labour or services
(B) Payments made by the government to individuals without any corresponding production of goods or services
(C) Payments made by businesses to their shareholders as a share of profits
(D) Payments made by individuals to the government in the form of taxes

Q.18

The Nuakhai festival of _____ is observed on Panchami Tithi (fifth day) of the lunar fortnight of Bhadrava (August-September), the day after Ganesh Chaturthi.

(A) Odisha
(B) Assam
(C) Meghalaya
(D) West Bengal

Q.19
Which country is hosting the ICC 2023 ODI Cricket World Cup?

(A) Pakistan
(B) South Africa
(C) India
(D) Australia

Q.21
In April 2023, Tamil Nadu passed a bill banning which of the following?

(A) Gutka
(B) Online Gambling
(C) Lottery
(D) Liquor

Q.22
In which stadium was the final match of ODI Cricket World Cup 2011 played?

(A) Eden Gardens
(B) Wankhede Stadium
(C) Feroz Shah Kotla Stadium
(D) D Y Patil Stadium

Q.23
'Mitra Mela' was a revolutionary organisation founded by:

(A) Bhupendra Nath Bose
(B) Khudiram Bose
(C) Vinayak Savarkar
(D) Sisir Kumar Bose

Q.25
Who among the following freedom fighter lawyers from Bengal is known as Deshbandhu?

(A) Chittaranjan Das
(B) Durga Mohan Das
(C) Bipin Chandra Pal
(D) Satish Ranjan Das

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. He studies the subject known as "the scientific study of insects."

(A) Entomology
(B) Alchemy
(C) Biology
(D) Etymology

Q.2
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. Harish told me / in the morning / that Gaurav will / come tomorrow.

(A) come tomorrow
(B) Harish told me
(C) that Gaurav will
(D) in the morning

Q.3
Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence. The detective and his agent inspected the krime scene yesterday.

(A) krime
(B) yesterday
(C) agent
(D) detective

Q.4
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Cup of tea

(A) Long held desire
(B) A cup brimming with tea
(C) Favourite pastime
(D) Something one likes/excels in

Q.5

Select the most appropriate segment that can substitute the underlined word in the following sentence. Iraq was governed by “autocracy” when Saddam Hussain was the President.

(A) one man with absolute power
(B) the King and his heir
(C) the wealthy class
(D) the common people

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Ours is _____ house of all the houses in our area.

(A) the more bigger
(B) the biggest
(C) the most biggest
(D) the bigger

Q.7

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Tastimonial
(B) Ballad
(C) Rampant
(D) Beneficiary

Q.8

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The council president is known “to play devil’s advocate” often.

(A) To allow others to rise
(B) To play risky games
(C) To argue, just for the sake of it
(D) Make one’s own destiny

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence. When it comes to playing the guitar, Jim always “hits the nail on the head”.

(A) Is dishonest
(B) Misses the point
(C) Does something right
(D) Makes a mistake

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The company was “on thin ice”.

(A) In a situation of comfort
(B) Forcing itself to collaborate
(C) Depending on business competitors
(D) In a precarious or risky situation

Q.12

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. She performed / the dance routine / perfect, / impressing everyone.

(A) She performed
(B) perfect
(C) impressing everyone
(D) the dance routine

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. With all their little comforts destroyed, the survivors were thrown “still farther back into barbarism.”

(A) still further back for barbarism
(B) still further back into barbarism
(C) No improvement required
(D) still a little farther into barbarism

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Perhaps my family visit the Taj Mahal next month.

(A) next month
(B) Perhaps
(C) the Taj Mahal
(D) my family visit

Q.15

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. In America, / most of the people / can speak / the English well.

(A) the English well
(B) most of the people
(C) can speak
(D) In America,

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Butterfly was “attracted” towards the bright flowers.

(A) Reckoned
(B) Repulsed
(C) Reargued
(D) Recurred

Q.17

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Please / explain me / how this plan / did not work.

(A) did not work
(B) Please
(C) how this plan
(D) explain me

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Early childhood experiences have a _____ impact on brain development affecting learning, health, behaviour, and, ultimately, productivity and income.

(A) perfect
(B) profound
(C) basic
(D) superficial

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fragile

(A) Brittle
(B) Sturdy
(C) Unkempt
(D) Intense

Q.20

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. He was “admired” for introducing welfare programmes.

(A) Despised
(B) Confessed
(C) Appreciated
(D) Succeeded

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fingerprinting is the one of the methods of (1)_____ using the impression made by the minute ridge formation or patterns found on the fingertips. No two persons have exactly the same (2)_____ of ridge patterns, they remain unchanged throughout the life. Fingerprints may be classified and filled on the basis of the ridge patterns, setting up an identification system that is almost (3)_____ . Today, law enforcement agencies use computers to (4)_____ record fingerprints and to transmit them electronically to other agencies for comparison. By comparing fingerprints of the criminals with the recorded fingerprints, officials can establish (5)_____ proof of the presence or identity of a person.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) involvement
(B) satisfaction
(C) demonstration
(D) identification

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fingerprinting is the one of the methods of (1)_____ using the impression made by the minute ridge formation or patterns found on the fingertips. No two persons have exactly the same (2)_____ of ridge patterns, they remain unchanged throughout the life. Fingerprints may be classified and filled on the basis of the ridge patterns, setting up an identification system that is almost (3)_____ . Today, law enforcement agencies use computers to (4)_____ record fingerprints and to transmit them electronically to other agencies for comparison. By comparing fingerprints of the criminals with the recorded fingerprints, officials can establish (5)_____ proof of the presence or identity of a person.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) arrangement
(B) statement
(C) management
(D) settlement

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fingerprinting is the one of the methods of (1)_____ using the impression made by the minute ridge formation or patterns found on the fingertips. No two persons have exactly the same (2)_____ of ridge patterns, they remain unchanged throughout the life. Fingerprints may be classified and filled on the basis of the ridge patterns, setting up an identification system that is almost (3)_____ . Today, law enforcement agencies use computers to (4)_____ record fingerprints and to transmit them electronically to other agencies for comparison. By comparing fingerprints of the criminals with the recorded fingerprints, officials can establish (5)_____ proof of the presence or identity of a person.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) risky
(B) infallible
(C) unreliable
(D) fallible

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fingerprinting is the one of the methods of (1)_____ using the impression made by the minute ridge formation or patterns found on the fingertips. No two persons have exactly the same (2)_____ of ridge patterns, they remain unchanged throughout the life. Fingerprints may be classified and filled on the basis of the ridge patterns, setting up an identification system that is almost (3)_____ . Today, law enforcement agencies use computers to (4)_____ record fingerprints and to transmit them electronically to other agencies for comparison. By comparing fingerprints of the criminals with the recorded fingerprints, officials can establish (5)_____ proof of the presence or identity of a person.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) manually
(B) digitally
(C) mentally
(D) physically

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fingerprinting is the one of the methods of (1)_____ using the impression made by the minute ridge formation or patterns found on the fingertips. No two persons have exactly the same (2)_____ of ridge patterns, they remain unchanged throughout the life. Fingerprints may be classified and filled on the basis of the ridge patterns, setting up an identification system that is almost (3)_____ . Today, law enforcement agencies use computers to (4)_____ record fingerprints and to transmit them electronically to other agencies for comparison. By comparing fingerprints of the criminals with the recorded fingerprints, officials can establish (5)_____ proof of the presence or identity of a person.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) absolute

(B) doubt

(C) unconfirmed

(D) provisional

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.14 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.14 · Answer (A) ₹900

One year's interest is 1,020 − 980 = ₹40, so two years' interest is ₹80 and the sum is 980 − 80 = ₹900.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Kerala

The sea keeps Kerala's climate equable, so its day and night temperatures hardly differ; inland states such as Rajasthan, Punjab and Bihar have a much larger daily range.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam

Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarmel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy and Anita Ratnam all made their names in Bharatanatyam (Yamini Krishnamurthy was also a leading Kuchipudi dancer).

Q.4 · Answer (A) Karnataka

Karnataka beat Meghalaya 3-2 in the final in Riyadh on 4 March 2023, their first Santosh Trophy title since 1968-69, won when the state was still called Mysore.

Q.5 · Answer (C) It provides for the Supreme Court to be a court of record.

Article 129 makes the Supreme Court a court of record, with the power to punish for contempt of itself. Advisory opinions come under Article 143 and original jurisdiction under Article 131.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Mewati Gharana

Pandit Jasraj was the best-known vocalist of the Mewati gharana.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Cultural and educational rights

Articles 29 and 30 make up the Cultural and Educational Rights: protection of the interests of minorities and their right to set up and run educational institutions.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 9.2%

The Periodic Labour Force Survey's quarterly bulletin for January-March 2023, the eighteenth in the series, put the urban unemployment rate for women aged 15 and above at 9.2%, down from 10.1% a year earlier.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Troposphere

Almost all weather (clouds, rain, storms) forms in the troposphere, the lowest layer of the atmosphere. The lithosphere and asthenosphere are layers of the Earth, and the stratopause is the boundary at the top of the stratosphere.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Tripura

In the 2011 Census Tripura's literacy rate was about 87.2%, below Goa (88.7%), Mizoram (91.3%) and Kerala (94.0%).

Q.11 · Answer (C) Tamil Nadu

The Brihadeeswara temple at Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu, was built by the Chola king Rajaraja I.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Sale of government bonds

Selling bonds is borrowing, which creates a liability, so it is a capital receipt. Taxes, profits of public enterprises and grants from abroad are revenue receipts.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Aharya Abhinaya

Of the four abhinayas of the Natya Shastra, aharya covers costume, ornaments and make-up; angika is the body, vachika speech and song, and sattvika the inner emotional states.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Payments made by the government to individuals without any corresponding production of goods or services

Transfer payments, such as pensions, scholarships and old-age allowances, are paid by the government without any good or service in return.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Odisha
Nuakhai, the festival of the new rice harvest, is celebrated mainly in western Odisha.

Q.19 · Answer (C) India
When the exam was held (September 2023), India was preparing to host the 2023 ICC Men's Cricket World Cup on its own, played in October and November 2023.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Online Gambling
Governor R. N. Ravi gave his assent on 10 April 2023 to the Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Online Gambling and Regulation of Online Games Bill, which the Assembly had passed a second time on 23 March 2023 after he returned it.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Wankhede Stadium
India beat Sri Lanka in the 2011 World Cup final, played at the Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai, on 2 April 2011.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Vinayak Savarkar
Vinayak Damodar Savarkar and his brother Ganesh founded the Mitra Mela at Nasik in 1899; it became the Abhinav Bharat Society in 1904.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Chittaranjan Das
Chittaranjan Das, the Calcutta barrister and Swaraj Party leader, was called 'Deshbandhu', friend of the nation.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Entomology
'Entomology' is the scientific study of insects; 'etymology' is the study of the origin of words.

Q.2 · Answer (C) that Gaurav will
SSC's key gives 'that Gaurav will': after the past reporting verb 'told', the reported clause moves back, 'that Gaurav would come tomorrow'. 'Will' is also heard when the event is still to come, but the textbook rule is the backshift.

Q.3 · Answer (A) krime
The correct spelling is 'crime'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Something one likes/excels in
One's 'cup of tea' is something one likes or is good at, usually in the negative: 'Chess is not my cup of tea.'

Q.5 · Answer (A) one man with absolute power
'Autocracy' is government by one person who holds absolute power.

Q.6 · Answer (B) the biggest
'Of all the houses' needs the superlative, and 'biggest' already is one, so 'more' or 'most' cannot be added: 'the biggest'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Tastimonial
The correct spelling is 'testimonial'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) To argue, just for the sake of it
To 'play devil's advocate' is to argue against a view, not out of conviction but for the sake of argument.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Does something right
To 'hit the nail on the head' is to get something exactly right.

Q.11 · Answer (D) In a precarious or risky situation
To be 'on thin ice' is to be in a risky or precarious position.

Q.12 · Answer (B) perfect
How she performed needs an adverb: 'performed the dance routine perfectly'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) still further back into barbarism
SSC's key gives 'further': for a figurative distance, as in sliding back into barbarism, 'further' is preferred, with 'farther' traditionally kept for physical distance. Some writers use 'farther' figuratively too, so leaving the sentence as it is is arguable.

Q.14 · Answer (D) my family visit
'Next month' points to the future, so the verb needs 'will': 'Perhaps my family will visit the Taj Mahal next month.'

Q.15 · Answer (A) the English well
The name of a language takes no article: 'can speak English well'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Repulsed
To be 'attracted' is to be drawn towards something; its opposite is 'repulsed', driven away.

Q.17 · Answer (D) explain me
'Explain' does not take the person as a direct object: 'explain to me'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) profound
A 'profound' impact is a deep, far-reaching one, which fits effects that last into learning, health and income; 'superficial' says the opposite.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Brittle
'Fragile' means easily broken: 'brittle'. 'Sturdy' is its opposite.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Despised
To be 'admired' is to be regarded with respect and approval; its opposite is 'despised'. 'Appreciated' is close in meaning.

Q.21 · Answer (D) identification
Fingerprinting is a method of 'identification': the passage goes on to speak of an 'identification system' and of proving a person's identity.

Q.22 · Answer (A) arrangement
No two people share the same 'arrangement' of ridge patterns, that is, the way the ridges are laid out.

Q.23 · Answer (B) infallible
Patterns that are unique and never change give a system that is almost 'infallible', incapable of error; 'fallible', 'risky' and 'unreliable' say the opposite.

Q.24 · Answer (B) digitally
Computers record fingerprints 'digitally', which is what lets them be sent electronically to other agencies.

Q.25 · Answer (A) absolute
A match gives 'absolute' proof, complete and certain; 'provisional' and 'unconfirmed' would undercut the passage.

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